

Round 6 — Spa-Francorchamps

Ferrari 296 GT3 | Gran Turismo 7 | BOP: ON

■ RACE SPECIFICATIONS

Parameter	Value	Parameter	Value
Duration	60 minutes	Grid	Reverse
Tyre Wear	4x	Start	Rolling
Fuel	3x	Tuning	Brake Balance only
Weather	Random / Rain chance	Qualifying	10 min — Must use RS
Pit Rules	As necessary	Tyre Allowance	RM RH RS IM WET

■ SITUATION ASSESSMENT

Critical threats at 4x wear on this car:

Corner	Threat
Eau Rouge / Raidillon	MR compression loads rear hard. Hybrid torque can unsettle exit.
Pouhlon	Sustained lateral load kills right-rear progressively.
La Source exit	Sharp turn-in is a weapon but throttle oversteer is always present.
Bus Stop chicane	MR instability under braking. Cold or worn tyres amplify this.

Reverse grid rolling start = fighting through traffic. Protect the car early, do not chase lap times in Lap 1-3.

■ QUALIFYING PLAN — 10 min | Mandatory RS

- Out-lap: build tyre temps gently — do NOT push through Eau Rouge cold
- Flying lap 1: clean banker. No heroics. Get a time on the board.
- Flying lap 2: PUSH — RS peaks on lap 2 at Spa at 4x wear
- Lap 3: no meaningful improvement. Box and prepare tyre switch.
- Final sector: Blanchimont flat if confident. Bus Stop precise — don't ruin a clean lap.

You have 1 minute before race start to change compound. Switch to RM.

■ RACE STRATEGY — STINT PLAN

Stint	Tyre	Target Duration	Pit Lap Target	Notes
1	RM	~20–22 min	Lap 10–11	Manage rear in traffic. Do not push until clear air.
2	RM or RH	~20–22 min	Lap 21–22	Weather read. RH if tyre wear felt severe.
3 (if req.)	IM / WET / Remaining		—	Weather dependent. React early.

■ Do NOT start on RS. At 4x wear, RS dies in 15–18 min at Spa. RM is mandatory race start.

■ Two-stop is very possible. Be mentally prepared before the race.

■ FUEL PLAN — 3x Multiplier

Condition	Fuel Map	Reason
Normal running, clear air	Map 4	Standard — no sacrifice needed
Stuck in traffic, no overtake	Map 3	Save without hurting race position
Fuel short risk only	Map 2	Last resort — costs real lap time

Two stops with Map 4 throughout should be sufficient. Do not overthink fuel — tyres are the priority.

■ WEATHER PROTOCOL — This Decides the Race

Condition	Action
Stays dry throughout	RM → RM (two stops)
Heavy rain starts during stint	Box IMMEDIATELY for WET — do not wait
Light rain / drying line	Stay on RM until dangerous, then IM
Rain starts between stints	Take IM (not WET) — easier to manage on drying track
Drying in Stint 2 or 3	IM → RM when dry racing line forms

At Spa, getting caught on slicks in heavy rain costs 30+ seconds. React early, not late.

■ BRAKE BALANCE PLAN

Phase	Setting	Reason
Race start (traffic)	-2 to -3	Front bias for stable stops in traffic
Mid-race (clear air)	-1 to -2	Less front as rears warm up
Final stint (worn tyres)	0 to -1	Worn rears — too much front will lock fronts

■ NEVER go positive. MR layout already rotates under braking. Positive bias = snap oversteer at La Source or Bus Stop.

■ KEY DRIVING NOTES — CORNER BY CORNER

EAU ROUGE / RAIDILLON

- Complete braking BEFORE the flick — no trail braking
- Smooth throttle over crest — hybrid torque makes exit tricky
- Commit fully, any hesitation = rear snap

LA SOURCE

- Sharp turn-in does the work — minimal trail brake needed
- Exit throttle: smooth and progressive — hybrid torque is instant
- Worn rubber: extra patience, the 296 bites suddenly

POUHON

- Right-rear degradation is constant. Budget for it.
- Slightly early apex, smooth progressive throttle
- On worn tyres: carry less speed, protect the tyre

BUS STOP CHICANE

- MR instability under heavy braking — front-biased balance critical
- Sharp turn-in helps direction changes but can over-rotate
- Don't defend aggressively — contact risk

BLANCHIMONT

- Flat on fresh tyres
- Worn tyres or damp: lift slightly — rear will wander
- If in doubt, lift. 0.2s beats a crash.

OVERTAKING ZONES:

- End of Kemmel Straight into Les Combes — best opportunity of the lap
- Out-braking into La Source from long straight — commit early or don't try
- Bus Stop chicane — high risk, last resort only

■ WHAT WILL LOSE THE RACE

1	Starting on RS	Dead in 15-18 min. Early pit destroys all reverse-grid progress.
2	Ignoring weather	Staying on slicks in rain at Spa is race-ending. React early.
3	Aggressive throttle exits	Hybrid torque overwhelms rear grip instantly. Smooth throttle only.
4	Positive brake balance	MR + positive bias = snap oversteer at Bus Stop or La Source.
5	Pitting too late on worn RM	You lose more time in the last 3 laps than you save avoiding the stop.

■ SIMPLE EXECUTION SUMMARY

QUALIFY RS → 2 flying laps → box
PRE-RACE Switch to RM in the 1-minute window
LAP 1-3 Survive traffic. No risks. Protect rears.
LAP 4-9 Find rhythm. Manage Pouhon and La Source exits.
LAP 10-11 PIT. Fresh RM (or RH if wear felt severe).
WEATHER Any rain signal → react immediately – don't wait
STINT 2 Push in clean air. Blanchimont flat on fresh rubber only.
FINAL STINT Rear protection mode. Brake balance to 0 or -1.
WIN ON CONSISTENCY.